A trillion dollars a year into data centres.

Who gets the return?

saro-saravanan.github.io/ai-workforce-sim

THE MONEY GOING IN · FOUR COMPANIES

Front-loaded.

- $413B in 2025
- $732B guided for 2026
- about $1.05T a year by 2030

OVER 2024 TO 2040

$15.6T

of capital, on the model’s path

THE MONEY COMING BACK TO THE BUILDERS

Producer revenue.

- $95B in 2026
- about $500B by 2030
- about $630B by 2040

CUMULATIVE PRODUCER REVENUE

$7.7T

Half the capital. It never catches up by 2040.

THE RETURN TO THE ECONOMY

Productivity gain.

- $1.4T a year by 2030
- $4.3T a year by 2040
- $35.6T cumulative · 2.3× the capital

PAYBACK

On productivity: 2033. On producer revenue: never within the horizon.

WHO KEEPS IT

The firms that adopt AI and, through lower prices, their customers.

Not the builders.

THE PATTERN

Railways. Electricity. Fibre.

Society earns the return; the builders earn a normal or poor one. Unless pricing power, or faster adoption, changes the answer.

Builders: a bet on pricing power. Adopters: a bet on execution.

Where is your portfolio?

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